Caring for the Caregiver — Speaker Notes

Friday, November 13, 2026 · 6:30–7:15 PM CT · Live on Zoom. Teaching runs about 35 minutes (slides in order), then questions to minute 45. Read the notes in your own words — they are a guide, not a script.

Slide 1 — Title / Welcome

[Minutes 0–2] Welcome everyone. Say: November is Family Caregivers Month, and tonight is different — tonight is not a class about forms. Tonight is for YOU, the ones who help everyone else. No cost, no sales pitch. Questions at the end; the ones sent in at registration come first.

Slide 2 — Tonight's Road Map

[Minutes 2–3] Read the road map out loud. Tell them: everything tonight is something you can do from home — this whole night was built for real caregiver life.

Slide 3 — Why Tonight Is About You

[Minutes 3–6] Speak from the heart. Many parents never hear anyone say this out loud. This is the heart of the night — slow down here.

Slide 4 — Signs You Are Running on Empty

[Minutes 6–10] Read the signs slowly — let them land. Say: if you nodded at two or more, tonight matters for you. Running on empty is normal for caregivers; it is not weakness, and it is not forever.

Slide 5 — First Help: Make Medication Time Easier

[Minutes 10–14] Practical and doable tonight. One list ends so much daily stress — no more guessing at the pharmacy or the doctor's office.

Slide 6 — Your Free Medication Check

[Minutes 14–18] This is the help caregivers look for most: medication costs. Explain plainly what the check is and that it costs nothing. Invite them to book one after class — first talk is free too.

Slide 7 — Money Basics for Caregiving Families

[Minutes 18–23] Gentle, no shame about money — ever. One page of bills is the start of every budget we build with a family. Just teach the step tonight; prices stay out of the class.

Slide 8 — Call and Ask: Bill Companies

[Minutes 23–27] Families are surprised this works. Phone, internet, and medical bills are the best first calls. The worst they can say is no — and often they say yes.

Slide 9 — Where Help Lives: 2-1-1

[Minutes 27–30] 2-1-1 is the front door to local help and Southern Oak is joining its listings. Tell them to save the number in their phone tonight.

Slide 10 — Real Breaks: Respite

[Minutes 30–33] Many parents have never heard the word respite. A rested caregiver is a safer caregiver. Encourage one small ask this month.

Slide 11 — One Small Break This Month

[Minutes 33–35] End the teaching with one doable step, not pressure. Then move to questions.

Slide 12 — Questions

[Minutes 35–45] Registered questions first, as promised. Keep group answers general; private details belong in the free talk.

Slide 13 — Thank You — and Happy Thanksgiving!

[Close] Thank them warmly and say Happy Thanksgiving. Remind them: the medication check and the first talk are free — we are here when they are ready.